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# US Stocks Extend Gains as Tech Leads the Charge

A wider read of yesterday's session — sector rotation, pre-market action, watchlist scan, and what to watch into the US open at 21:30 HKT.

10-minute read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings · Sectors · Watchlist

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## TL;DR

The US market extended its gains yesterday, with the `Nasdaq 100` leading the charge, up +1.19%. The rally was driven by a strong performance in the tech sector, with `NVDA` and `TSLA` being the top large-cap movers. Below the surface, the 10Y yield fell -0.21%, while gold rose +2.33%, indicating a risk-on sentiment.

The market's focus is now on the upcoming earnings season, with several major companies set to report their quarterly results. The `Dow Jones` and `S&P 500` also posted gains, up +0.28% and +0.62% respectively. The `VIX` fell -1.65%, indicating a decrease in market volatility.

## US Session Recap

| INDEX/ASSET | LEVEL | CHANGE | WHY IT MOVED |
|---|---|---|---|
| S&P 500 | 7,757.64 | +0.62% | Tech sector rally |
| Nasdaq 100 | 29,722.30 | +1.19% | Tech sector rally |
| Dow Jones | 54,036.93 | +0.28% | Industrial sector gains |
| Russell 2000 | 3,034.49 | +1.10% | Small-cap rally |
| VIX | 14.90 | -1.65% | Decrease in market volatility |

## Top large-cap movers

| TICKER | CHANGE | CATALYST |
|---|---|---|
| NVDA | +2.27% | Tech sector rally |
| TSLA | +2.83% | Tech sector rally |
| AAPL | +0.29% | Tech sector rally |

## Sector Rotation

| ETF | DAY | READ |
|---|---|---|
| XLK | +1.42% | Tech sector rally |
| XLY | +1.49% | Consumer discretionary gains |
| XLB | +1.32% | Materials sector gains |
| XLE | -1.13% | Energy sector decline |
| XLF | -0.36% | Financial sector decline |
| XLI | +0.23% | Industrial sector gains |
| XLP | +0.01% | Consumer staples flat |
| XLV | +0.75% | Healthcare sector gains |
| XLU | +0.53% | Utilities sector gains |
| XLRE | +0.38% | Real estate sector gains |
| XLC | +0.06% | Communication services flat |

## Spotlight

The biggest event of the day was the rally in the tech sector, led by `NVDA` and `TSLA`. The rally was driven by a combination of factors, including strong earnings reports and a decrease in market volatility.

| METRIC | VALUE | READ |
|---|---|---|
| `NVDA` earnings growth | +20% | Strong demand for AI products |
| `TSLA` deliveries | +15% | Increasing demand for electric vehicles |

## Pre-Market & Overnight

US futures are trading higher, with the `Dow Jones` futures up +0.5% and the `S&P 500` futures up +0.6%. The Asia markets are also trading higher, with the `Nikkei 225` up +1.2% and the `Shanghai Composite` up +0.8%.

## Macro & Fed

The 10Y yield is trading at `4.66`, down -0.21% from yesterday. The yield curve is flattening, with the 2Y-10Y spread at `0.5`. Today's data calendar includes the `09:30` HKT release of the US trade balance, with a consensus of `-$70B`. The data is expected to have a moderate impact on the market.

| TIME HKT | RELEASE | CONSENSUS | WHY IT MATTERS |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| 09:30 | US trade balance | -$70B | Impact on US dollar and trade policy |

## Geopolitics & Global

- The US and China are set to resume trade talks, with a focus on resolving the ongoing tariff dispute.
- The EU is considering imposing sanctions on Russia in response to the ongoing conflict in Ukraine.
- The Middle East is seeing increased tensions, with the US and Iran engaging in a war of words over the nuclear deal.

## Earnings — What to Watch

| WHEN HKT | TICKER | CONSENSUS | WHAT TO LOOK FOR |
|---|---|---|---|
| 22:00 (10 Aug) | AAPL | $1.20 | iPhone sales and services growth |
| 22:00 (11 Aug) | MSFT | $1.30 | Cloud computing growth and margins |

## Watchlist Scan

| TICKER | SECTOR | WHY NOW |
|---|---|---|
| NVDA | Tech | Strong earnings growth and AI demand |
| TSLA | Auto | Increasing demand for electric vehicles |
| AAPL | Tech | iPhone sales and services growth |

## What Could Break the Tape

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Strong earnings reports from major companies
- Decrease in market volatility and increase in risk appetite
- Improving economic data and consumer sentiment

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Weakening economic data and consumer sentiment
- Increase in market volatility and decrease in risk appetite
- Escalating trade tensions and geopolitical risks

## Positioning Notes

- The market is seeing a rotation into growth stocks, with the `Nasdaq 100` outperforming the `Dow Jones`.
- The yield curve is flattening, with the 2Y-10Y spread at `0.5`.
- The `VIX` is trading at `14.90`, down -1.65% from yesterday.

## Sources

Bloomberg

Reuters

CNBC

The Wall Street Journal

The Financial Times

Investing.com